AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF BEIRUT

SULIMAN S. OLAYAN SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

Executive Education

THE BUSINESS CENTRIC

DESIGN THINKING

With today's rapidly evolving customers' needs, organizations are undergoing increased pressure to innovate and constantly adapt to their customers' changing requirements. The shift from a centrally dedicated innovation entity to a team-based and cross-functional effort requires some fundamental changes to the traditional innovation mindset and adopted methodologies.

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OVERVIEW

The Innovate to Elevate Program, developed by the American University of Beirut, Suliman S. Olayan School of Business (OSB), explores the needed requirements for enabling customer focused innovation that is key for facing increasingly competitive environments. It focuses on enabling teams to turn innovative ideas into execution through design thinking. Participants will get the opportunity to understand the principles of design thinking and apply them in team-based activities. The activities focus on how to: empathize with customers to identify their needs and relevant problems; rapidly experiment with multiple customer-centric solutions; and test the proposed solution. Through a combination of guided hands-on activities, participants will be equipped with a set of skills that can be transferred to and applied in the context of their organization.

INSTRUCTOR FOUAD ZABLITH, PHD

Fouad Zablith is Associate Professor of Business Information and Decision Systems, and Associate Dean of Online Learning and Program Development at the Olayan School of Business of the American University of Beirut.

As part of his research, Dr. Zablith explores the potentials of emerging information and knowledge technologies to help people and organizations reach their objectives. His research appeared in several peer-reviewed conference proceedings, book chapters, and journals such as Artificial Intelligence, Journal of Business Research, Long Range Planning, and others.

Dr. Zablith teaches business and data analytics subjects in the undergraduate, graduate, and executive education programs, related to information systems, data visualization, operations research, and human-centered innovation.

HOW YOU BENEFIT

Understand the core requirements for innovation initiatives to meet today's rapidly changing customers' needs.

Understand the principles of Design Thinking is one of the best means for generating and filtering ideas that can turn into successful innovations.

Apply the Design Thinking methodology to generate innovative customer-centered solutions.

AACSB ACCREDITED

WHY THIS PROGRAM

1. Innovative. It delivers an updated perspective on innovation mindset through design thinking process.
2. Practical. It provides you with hands-on experience of the application of tools and techniques.
3. Short and Effective. It is designed to suit your busy schedule and aims to provide you with the know-how in 3 days.
4. Highly engaging. It includes case studies, interactive discussions, hands-on exercises, and individual contributions.

WHO SHOULD ENROLL

AUB alumni, looking to reconnect with the AUB network and renew their learning journey.

Executives, managers, and decision-makers seeking insights into customer-centric solutions through team-based innovation.

Entrepreneurs and business owners, aiming to enhance products and services to a changing customer base.

Note: Participants generally come from different sectors and industries, No prior technical or coding experience is required, Proficiency in spoken and written English is necessary.

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Duration: 3 days

Dates: Q2 or 3, 2026

Fees: $1,000

Fees for AUB Alumni: $800

Location: American University of Beirut Suliman S. Olayan School of Business, (OSB) campus Beirut – Lebanon